Obed Mathias Gaiya

Senior Backend Engineer · Fintech & Payments

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Summary

Senior backend engineer with 8+ years building distributed systems and 3 years in fintech across Nigeria and the UAE: digital wallets, lending and risk scoring, payroll, invoice financing, settlements, open banking, and payment integrations. Builds money-safe systems with ledgers, idempotency, webhooks, reconciliation, and KYC. Previously scaled WorkNation to 100K+ requests per second at 99.9% uptime.

Fintech highlights

- **Wallets and conversational banking:** Wallets for event money-spraying (DigiSpray) and earned-wage payroll (Juiceme); WhatsApp money products (Zuka, Juiceme).
- **Lending and open banking:** Loan, invoice financing, and settlement services with lender risk scoring, Lean Technologies open banking, and Emirates NBD integration (FracXn).
- **Payment engineering:** Ledger-based balances, reconciliation, idempotent APIs, webhooks, KYC, and Stripe; open-source Fincra Checkout SDKs.
- **Finance operations and identity:** QuickBooks, Zoho Books, and Wafeq automation, OCR document extraction, and UAE PASS digital identity.

Core skills

- **Fintech:** wallets, ledgers, reconciliation, idempotency, webhooks, KYC, risk scoring, lending, payroll, settlements, open banking, payment and bank integrations
- **Backend:** Java, Spring Boot, Node.js (NestJS, Express, AdonisJS), TypeScript, PHP (Laravel), REST APIs, WebSockets, microservices, event-driven design, caching
- **Data and DevOps:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions
- **Also:** React, Next.js, Vue.js, React Native, Flutter, Jest, Mocha; technical leadership and mentoring

Fintech experience

Software Engineer (Contract) — DigiSpray LLC

Lagos, Nigeria · 2025 – Present

- Building DigiSpray, a digital money-spraying platform for events: guests top up wallets, spray money and send gifts in real time, and celebrants withdraw to their banks.
- Built the wallet engine for top-ups, sprays, gifting, and withdrawals, keeping balances accurate during bursts of simultaneous transactions at live events.

- Implemented ledger-based balances, idempotency keys against duplicate sprays, verified webhooks, reconciliation with provider records, and KYC checks.
- Leading the rebuild of the web and mobile platform and core business logic, cutting technical debt and speeding up new payment features.

Software Engineer (Contract) — Zuka Solutions Limited

Nigeria · 2024 – 2025

- Built Zuka, a WhatsApp money assistant for balances, activity, receipts, transfers, and payments through chat, running on partner financial infrastructure.
- Built review-and-approve transfer flows showing recipient, amount, and fees, plus status tracking that prevents duplicate sends.
- Built secure identity verification and onboarding outside the chat, with stronger checks for higher-risk actions.

Senior Software Engineer (Contract) — FracXn

Dubai, UAE · 2024 – 2025

- Built backend services for four financial products (loan apps, payroll, invoice financing, and instant settlements), including risk scoring that helps lenders assess borrower creditworthiness.
- Integrated Lean Technologies open banking, Emirates NBD banking services, and Stripe for account data, settlements, and customer payments.
- Implemented ledger-based balances, idempotent payment APIs, webhook handling, reconciliation, and KYC across loan and settlement flows.
- Automated finance operations with OCR document extraction and QuickBooks, Zoho Books, and Wafeq integrations; implemented UAE PASS digital identity for onboarding.

Lead Software Engineer (Contract) — Juice Technology

Lagos, Nigeria · 2023 – 2024

- Built a NestJS wallet for Juiceme, an earned-wage product that lets employers pay staff any day, with ledger balances, idempotent payouts, webhooks, reconciliation, and KYC.
- Brought payroll into WhatsApp through Infobip chatbots, and led architecture for the HR and payroll SaaS platform and its Laravel Nova finance dashboards.

Engineering leadership experience

Lead Software Engineer (Full Time) — Outsource Global (WorkNation)

Abuja, Nigeria · 2021 – 2025

- Scaled the WorkNation platform to 100K+ requests per second at 99.9% uptime, migrating to microservices and cutting API response times by 40% with caching.
- Set code review standards that reduced defects by 30%, mentored engineers, and delivered multiple projects from concept to production on schedule.
- Built a coding challenge platform that made technical hiring 60% more efficient.

Earlier experience

- **Software Engineer and Lead Instructor (Contract), Tribesquare Inc.** · 2021
- **Software Engineer (Contract), Afropolis** · 2020 – 2021
- **Software Engineering Instructor, Campus Technologies (NIIT)** · 2019 – 2021
- **Junior Software Engineer, Ogohtech Computers** · 2017 – 2018

Open source

- **react-native-fincra-checkout** and **flutter_fincra_checkout** — Production-ready React Native and Flutter SDKs for Fincra Checkout payments · github.com/gaiyadev/react-native-fincra-checkout · pub.dev/packages/flutter_fincra_checkout
- **nestjs-drizzle-orm** — NestJS module for Drizzle ORM (PostgreSQL, MySQL) · npmjs.com/package/nestjs-drizzle-orm

Education and certifications

- **B.Sc. Mathematics**, Kaduna State University · 2012 – 2017
- Postgraduate Diploma, Project Management
- Software Architecture (Udemy, 2022) · DevOps (Udemy)